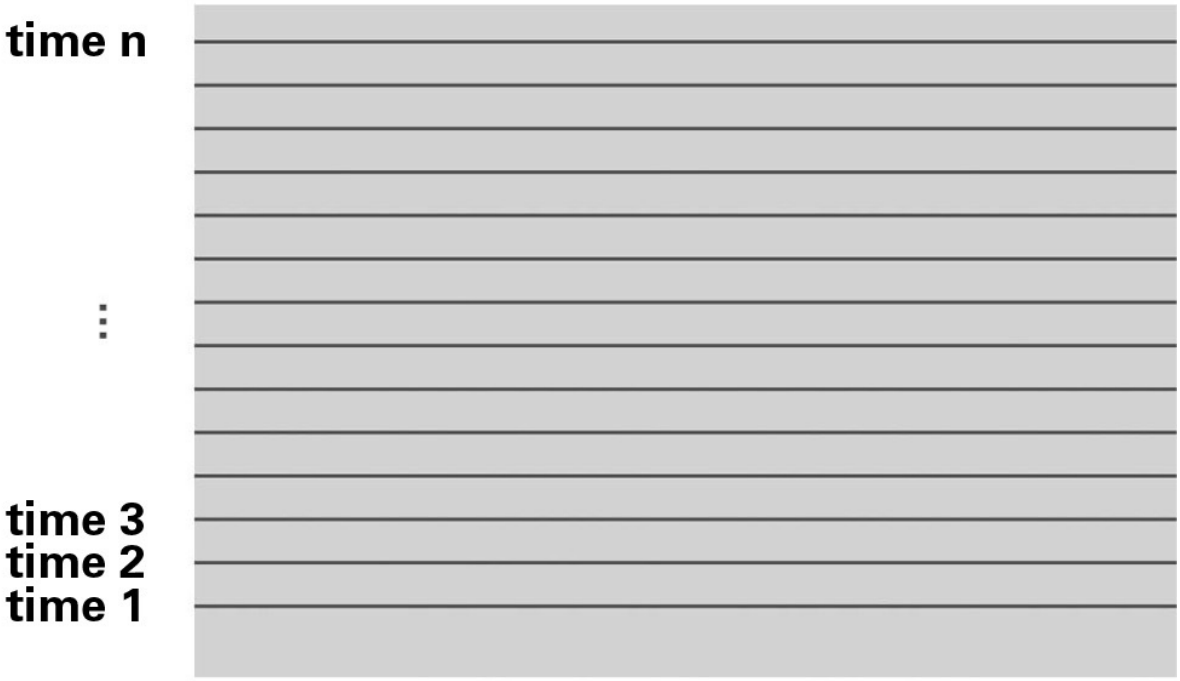
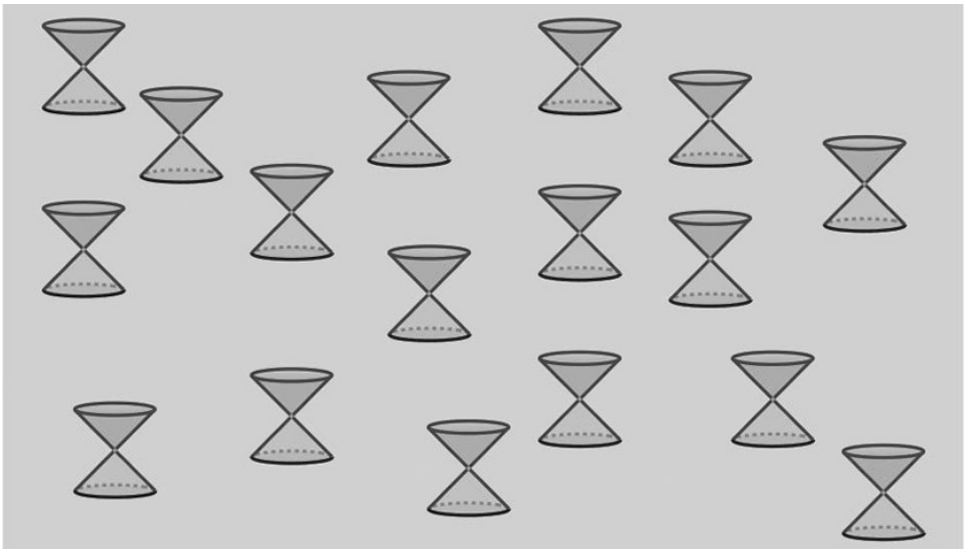




They are like a sequence of photographs of a man running, or a book containing a story that develops over many years. They are a schematic representation of a possible *history* of the world, not of one of its single, instantaneous states.

The first diagram illustrates how we used to think of the temporal structure of the world *before* Einstein. The set of real events *now*, at a given time, is shown in gray: